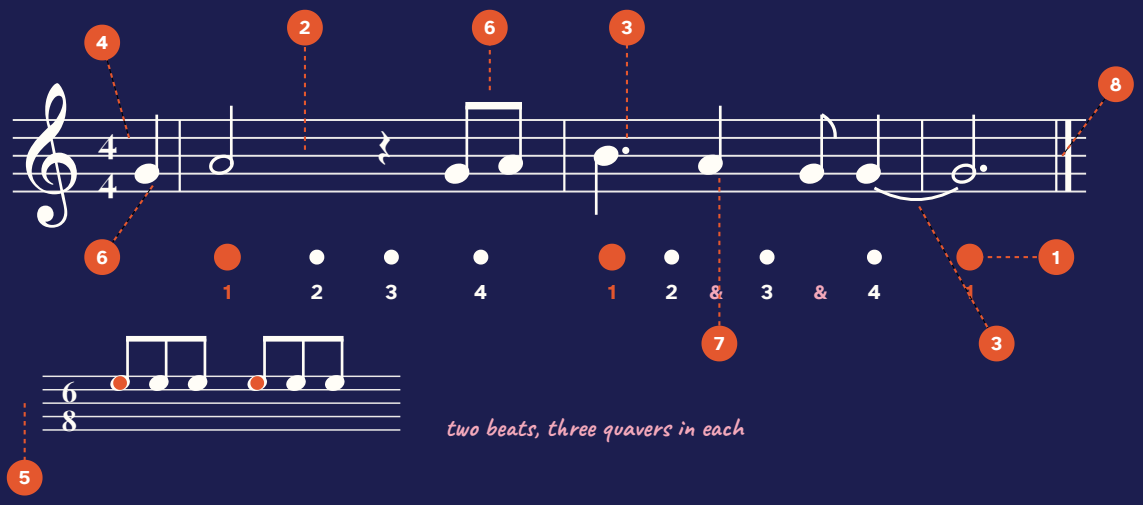
PART II · WHEN, AND FOR HOW LONG

Time

Music never stands still. Underneath runs a steady **pulse**, packed into **bars**, and every note and rest gets its fair share. Everything in this part is in these two bars.



1 **Pulse, tempo and the bar** p. 50
the steady beat underneath; beat 1 is strongest

2 **Notes and rests** p. 53
the shape says how long; rests are counted too

3 **How long is a note?** p. 56
a dot adds half; a tie glues two notes into one

4 **Time signatures** p. 59
four seats in every bar, a crotchet in each

5 **Compound and irregular time** p. 62
beats in threes; bars of five or seven

6 **Rhythm: groups and upbeats** p. 65
beams show the beats; starting before bar 1

7 **Rhythm: off the beat** p. 68
a note between the beats that holds on

8 **Repeats and road signs** p. 71
repeat signs, D.C., D.S., Fine and Coda

★ **Tips: when the rhythm slips** p. 74

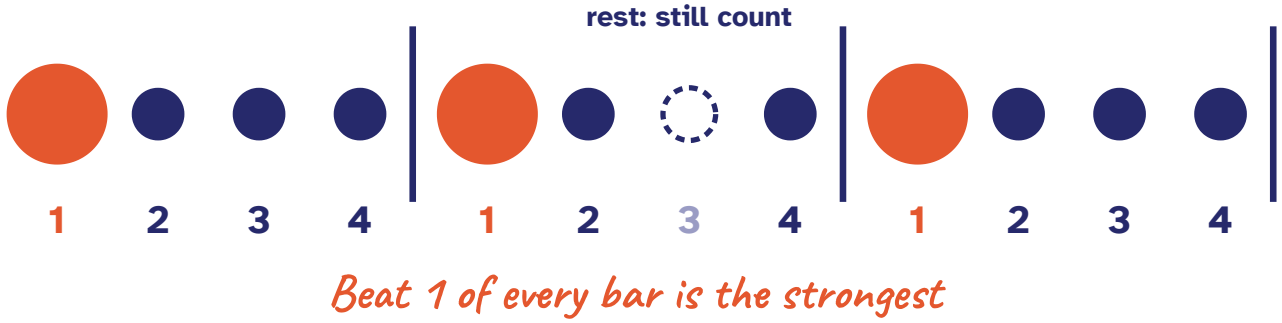
PART II · TIME · 1

Pulse, tempo and the bar

Put your hand on your heart: that steady beat is a **pulse**, and almost every piece has one. Its speed is the **tempo**. Beats travel in groups called **bars**, and beat 1 is the strongest.

THE SECRET

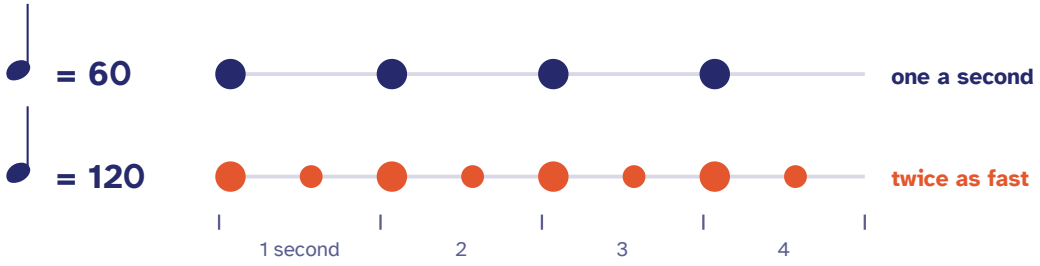
The beat never stops, not even in a rest. Feel it before you play.



Beat 1 of every bar is the strongest

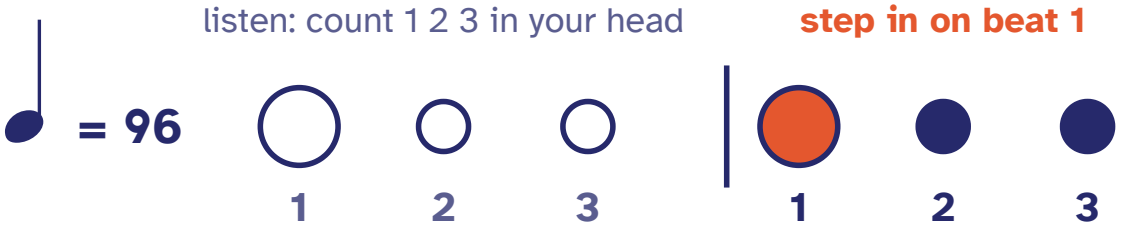
Tempo

Tempo is measured in beats per minute. A **metronome mark** at the top of the music shows it: ♩ **= 60** means 60 crotchet beats a minute, one beat a second. ♩ **= 120** is twice as fast. Speed words such as *Andante* and *Allegro* are on p. 82.



EXAMPLE 1

Feel the beat before you play

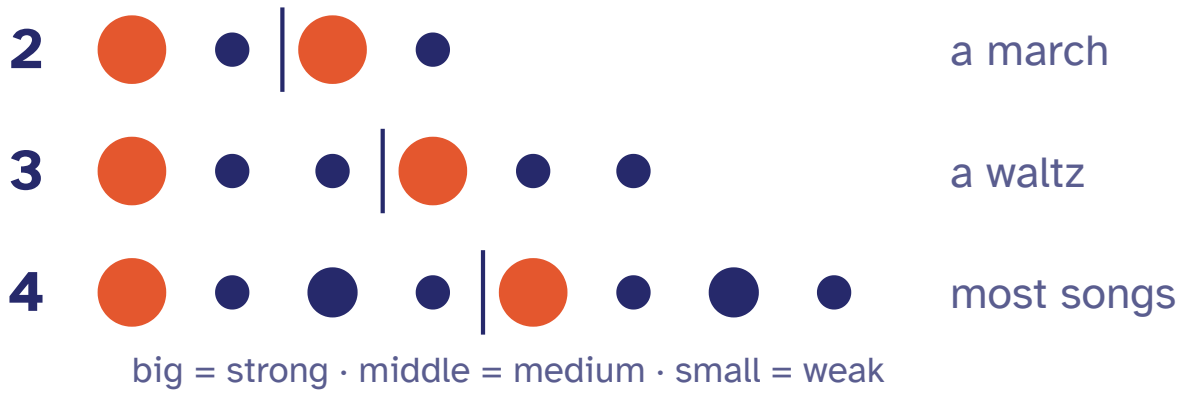


1. **Read the mark:** ♩ **= 96**, 96 crotchet beats a minute.
2. **Listen first:** set the metronome and let one full bar go by, counting "1 2 3" in your head.
3. **Step in** on the next beat 1, the way you step onto a moving escalator.

The first note lands **on the beat**, not a guess.

PART II · TIME · 1 · CONTINUED

Strong and weak beats



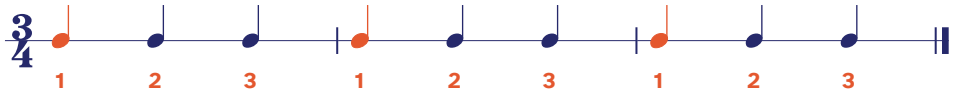
big = strong · middle = medium · small = weak

In tunes you know

TUNE	BEATS IN A BAR	PATTERN
Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star	4	**Strong** weak **medium** weak
Happy Birthday	3	**Strong** weak weak
The Blue Danube (a waltz)	3	**Strong** weak weak
Radetzky March	2	**Strong** weak

EXAMPLE 2

Is this a march or a waltz?



1. **Tap a steady beat** as you listen.
2. **Which beats feel heavier?** The red notes help.
3. **Count from one heavy beat to the next.** How many?

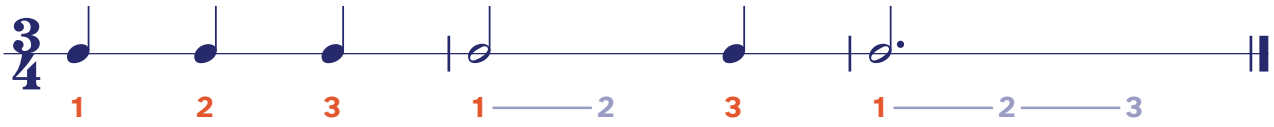
Heavy every three: 1 2 3, 1 2 3. A **waltz**. Every two would be a march.

Bars and bar lines

SIGN	NAME	MEANING
	bar line	divides the music into bars
	double bar line	marks the end of a section, or a change of time signature or tempo
	final bar line	marks the end of the piece
	repeat signs	play the passage between them again; if there is no start sign, go back to the beginning

PART II · TIME · 1 · CONTINUED

Counting



Three bars of 3/4 (the sign at the start: three beats in each bar, p. 59). Every beat is counted, even inside a long note: the red number is where you play, the grey numbers are the beats you hold.

Count aloud at one speed, a little louder on beat 1. With a metronome, start slower than you think and speed up only when the passage is steady.

TRY IT · 10 SECONDS



Hand on your heart. Tap the beat.

Say “1 2 3 4” with your taps, 1 a little louder. Keep going for ten seconds without slowing down.
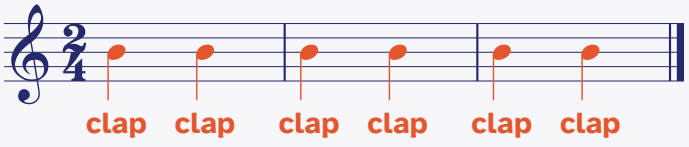
HOW TO

Find the beat of a new piece

1. **Read the time signature:** how many beats in each bar.
2. **Tap the beat** on your knee before you play, counting one bar aloud.
3. **Start slower** than the marked speed, and keep it steady to the end.

YOU KNOW THIS

Radetzky March (Johann Strauss I)



At the New Year concert the audience claps along on **every beat**. That steady clap is the pulse; the orchestra’s tune moves freely over it.

Try it. Put on any march and clap only the beat, not the tune.

THINK OF IT The beat is the stage and the notes are the actors: the stage is there before anyone walks on. Step in as you would onto an escalator: watch it move for a bar, then join in.

TRAP

- × Speeding up in easy bars and slowing in hard ones: the pulse never changes.
- × Counting only the notes you play: the beat goes on through long notes and rests.

SEE ALSO
Time signatures p. 59 · Speed words p. 82

PRACTISE IT
Workbook pp. 1–2 · Online: Metronome
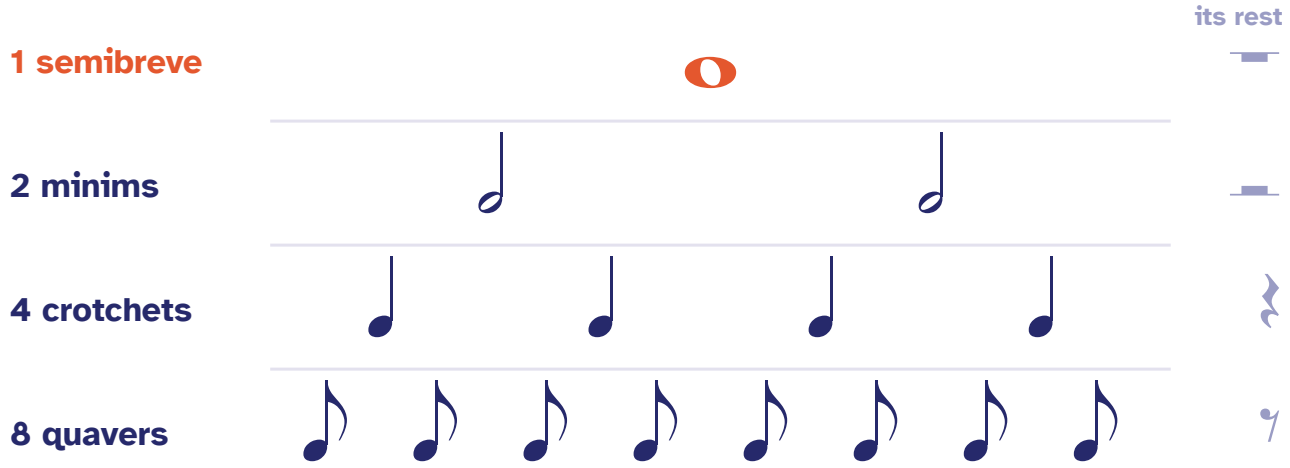
PART II · TIME · 2

Notes and rests

Music is made of sounds and silences. A **note** shows how long a sound lasts; a **rest** shows how long a silence lasts, and you count it just as carefully.

THE SECRET

Each note is half the one above it, and every note has a rest twin.

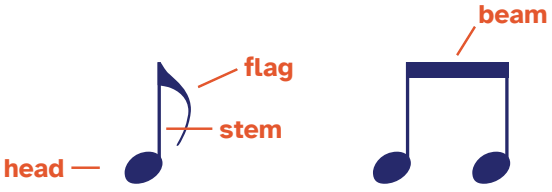


Each note splits into two of the next
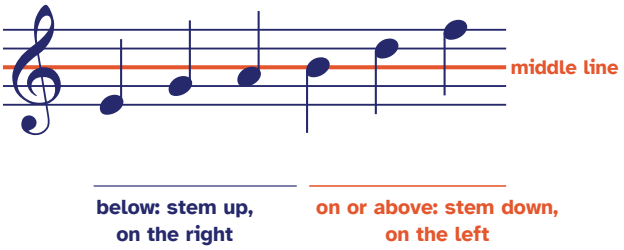
Counting quavers: say the beat's number, then "&" halfway to the next beat: "1 & 2 & 3 & 4 &".

Head, stem, flag

The **head** sits on a line or in a space. Every note but the semibreve has a **stem**. A **flag** halves the note; quavers side by side share a **beam** instead.



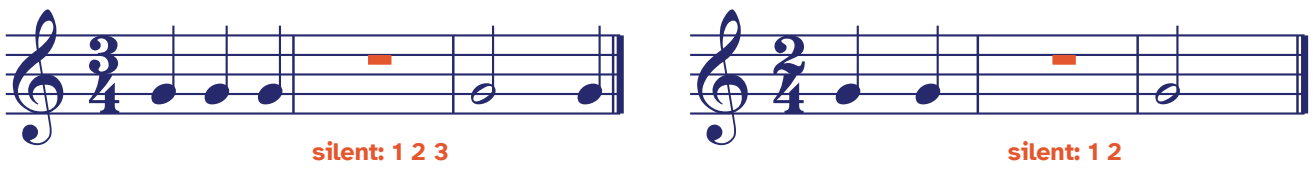
Which way does the stem go?



The stem never changes the note's length: it only keeps the page tidy.
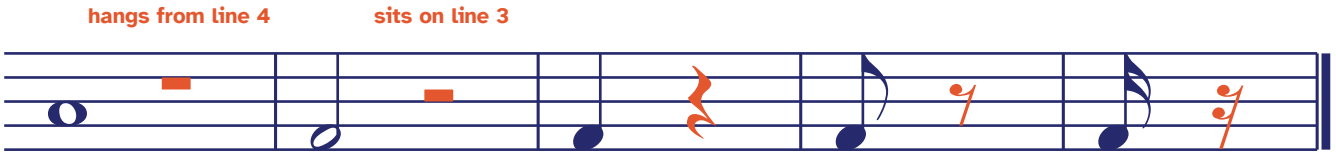
THE SEMIBREVE REST'S SPECIAL POWER

Most rests last a fixed number of beats. The **semibreve rest** can also mean **a whole bar of silence** in any time signature: 4 beats in 4/4, but 3 in 3/4 and 2 in 2/4. It is then centred in the bar. No other rest can do this.



PART II · TIME · 2 · CONTINUED

Every note has a twin rest



semibreve	**minim**	**crotchet**	**quaver**	**semiquaver**
note and rest: 4 beats	note and rest: 2 beats	note and rest: 1 beat	note and rest: ½ beat	note and rest: ¼ beat

Same length, no sound. The two big rests look alike: the **semibreve rest hangs** from line 4, heavy as a coat on a hook; the **minim rest sits** on line 3, like a hat.

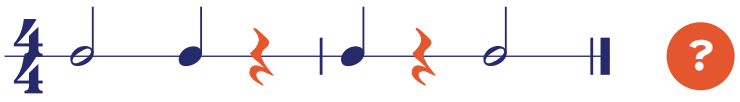
Why whole, half and quarter?

Think of each beat as a pizza. A bar of 4/4 is four pizzas. The note that fills a whole bar of 4/4 is the **whole note**; the others are a half, a quarter, an eighth and a sixteenth of it. Two quavers beamed together fill one pizza. A rest is the same share left empty: shaded with lines.

semibreve	whole note	4 pizzas · 4 beats	
semibreve rest	silence	4 beats, or a whole bar	
minim	half note	2 pizzas · 2 beats	
minim rest	silence	2 empty pizzas · 2 beats	
crotchet	quarter note	1 pizza · 1 beat	
crotchet rest	silence	1 empty pizza · 1 beat	
quaver	eighth note	half a pizza · ½ beat	
quaver rest	silence	half an empty pizza · ½ beat	
semiquaver	sixteenth note	a quarter of a pizza · ¼ beat	
semiquaver rest	silence	a quarter of an empty pizza · ¼ beat	

EXAMPLE 1

How long is each sound, and each silence?



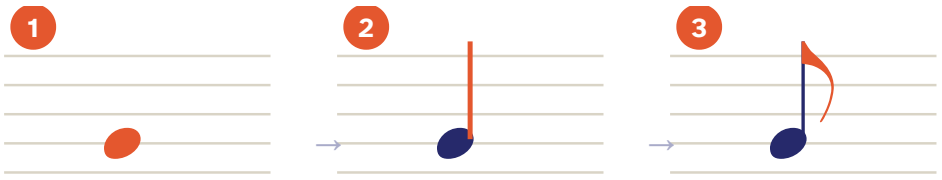
1. **Name each shape** in the bar.
2. **How many beats** does each one last?
3. **Add them up,** rests included. What is the total?

Minim 2, crotchet 1, crotchet rest 1: every bar adds up to **4 beats**, silences included.

PART II · TIME · 2 · CONTINUED

How to draw notes and rests

Draw them yourself: it is the quickest way to remember them.



an oval, tilted
filled or hollow

a stem, 3 spaces tall
up on the right

a flag, curling right
for a quaver



semibreve rest
a block hanging under line 4

minim rest
a block sitting on line 3

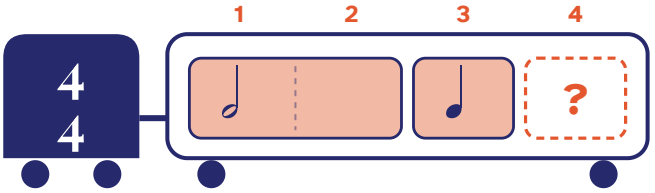
crotchet rest
draw a Z, then a little c

quaver rest
a 7 with a dot on top

semiquaver rest
a 7 with two dots

EXAMPLE 2

Fill a bar of 4/4: what goes in the last seat?
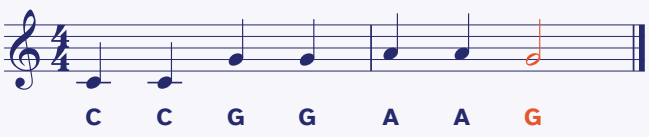


1. **How many seats** does the minim take?
2. **And the crotchet?**
3. **How many seats are left** for a silence, and which rest fills one seat?

2 + 1 = 3, one seat left: a **crotchet rest**. The bar is full.

YOU KNOW THIS

Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star



Six **crotchets**, then a **minim** at the end of the line: one beat, one beat … and two beats to breathe.

SEE ALSO
Pulse, tempo and the bar p. 50 · How long is a note? p. 56

PRACTISE IT
Workbook pp. 3–4 · Online: Library › Notes

PART II · TIME · 3

How long is a note?

Sometimes a note needs a length no single shape gives, like three beats, or a sound that carries across the bar line. Two little signs stretch it.

THE SECRET
A dot adds half. A tie glues two notes into one.

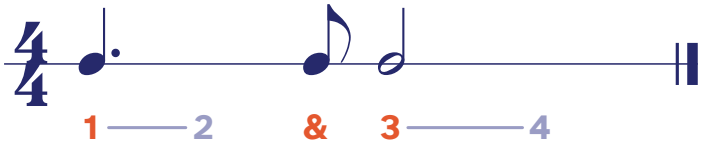


2 beats **2 + 1 = 3 beats**

The dot adds half

The dot

A dot adds **half the note's value**: a dotted minim lasts 2 + 1 = 3 beats; a dotted crotchet 1 + ½ = 1½.



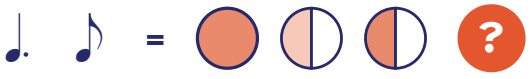
The dot, in pizzas

The dot is a helper that adds **half of whatever its note is worth**. Dark slices: the note. Lighter: what the dot adds.

dotted minim		2 + **1** (half of 2) = **3 beats**
dotted crotchet		1 + **½** (half of 1) = **1½ beats**
dotted quaver		½ + **¼** (half of ½) = **¾ beat**

EXAMPLE 1

How many beats: a dotted crotchet and a quaver?
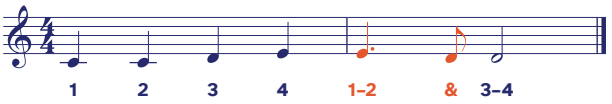


1. **The dotted crotchet:** 1 beat plus half of 1.
2. **The quaver:** half a beat.
3. **Add them.** Where does the quaver fall?

1½ + ½ = **2 beats**. The quaver lands on the "&" of beat 2: "1 (&) 2 **&**".

PART II · TIME · 3 · CONTINUED

EXAMPLE 2

A dotted crotchet you already know: Ode to Joy



1. **Bars 3–4 of Beethoven's Ode to Joy.** Sing it: "C C D E, E — D D".
2. **The red E is a dotted crotchet:** 1 + ½ = 1½ beats, held through "1 & 2".
3. **The quaver D** falls on the "&" of beat 2; the last D takes beats 3 and 4.

Long–short, then long: the dot is why the tune **leans** before it lands.

EXTRA · GOING FURTHER

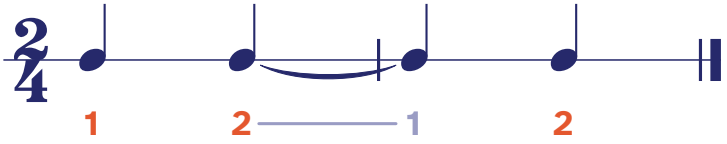
The double dot

A second dot adds half of the first dot. Rare before the higher Levels.



The tie

A curve joining two notes **of the same pitch** makes one longer sound: play the first, hold through the second, and never play it again. Ties can cross a bar line, where a dot cannot.



EXAMPLE 3

Dot or tie: which is longer?



1. **The dotted minim:** a dot adds half. How many beats?
2. **The tied notes:** add the two notes together.
3. **Compare** the two totals.

Both last **3 beats**: the same length. A tie can also cross a bar line, which a dot cannot.

PART II · TIME · 3 · CONTINUED

EXAMPLE 4

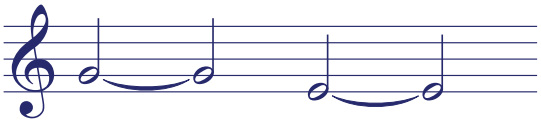
Which is longer: a dotted minim or a minim tied to a quaver?



1. **Dotted minim:** add half of 2. How many pizzas?
2. **Minim tied to a quaver:** add the two.
3. **Compare** the totals.

3 against 2½: the **dotted minim** is longer, by half a beat.

Tie or slur?



Tie: the same pitch. Play once and hold: G for 4 beats, then E for 4.



Slur: different pitches. Play every note, smoothly joined (legato).

GAME

How many beats?



1 2 3

With a crotchet as one beat: how long does each one last?

Answer: 1 three (2 + 1) · 2 one and a half (1 + ½) · 3 three (2 tied to 1).

TRY IT · 10 SECONDS



Clap once, hold for three.

Say “1 2 3” as you hold: a dotted minim. Then a dotted crotchet and quaver: “1 (& 2) &”.

TRAP

- × Putting the dot on the wrong note: a dot adds half of **its own** note.
- × Tying two different pitches: that curve is a slur, not a tie.
- × Two kinds of dot: one **after** the head adds length; one **above or below** it means staccato.

SEE ALSO
Time signatures p. 59 · Rhythm: groups and upbeats p. 65

PRACTISE IT
Workbook pp. 5–6 · Online: Library

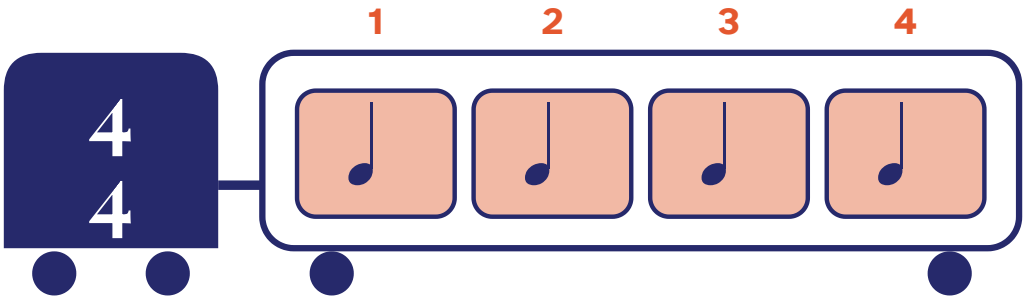
PART II · TIME · 4

Time signatures

Two numbers, like a train ticket: the **top number** says how many seats (counts) each bar has; the **bottom number** says which note fills one seat.

THE SECRET

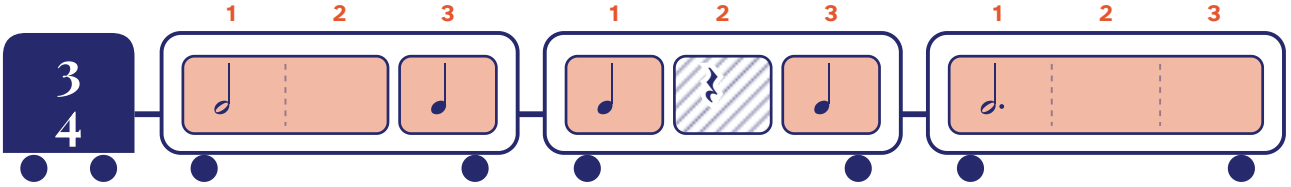
Top number: how many beats. Bottom number (in simple time): which note gets one beat.



Top: how many seats · bottom: which note sits in one

Think of a train

In 3/4 every carriage (bar) has exactly **3 seats**; each seat is one crotchet beat. Notes book seats: a minim takes 2, a crotchet 1. A rest books a seat and leaves it **empty** (shaded). Every seat in every carriage must be booked.



minim + crotchet · crotchet, crotchet rest, crotchet · dotted minim: 3 seats each

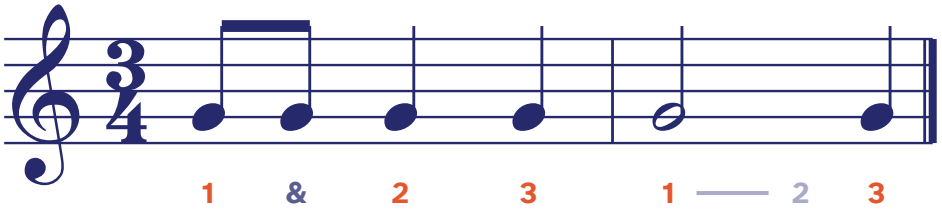
The bottom number

BOTTOM	NOTE	ONE COUNT IS A	FIRST MET
2	𝅗𝅥	minim	Level 3
4	♩	crotchet	Level 0
8	♪	quaver	Level 1
16	𝅘𝅥𝅯	semiquaver	*Extra*

PART II · TIME · 4 · CONTINUED

EXAMPLE 1

What does 3/4 mean?



1. **The top number:** how many counts in each bar?
2. **The bottom number:** 4 stands for a crotchet. Which note gets one count?
3. **Check a bar:** does it add up?

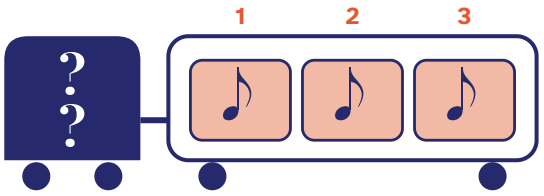
3/4: **three crotchet beats** in every bar (two quavers + crotchet + crotchet = 3).

Simple time: each beat divides in two

TIME SIGNATURE	EACH BAR HOLDS	FIRST MET
2/4	2 crotchets	Level 0
3/4	3 crotchets	Level 0
4/4 (C)	4 crotchets (the C sign: common time)	Level 0
2/2 (¢)	2 minims (the cut C: cut common time)	Level 3
3/2	3 minims	Level 3
4/2	4 minims	*Extra*
3/8	3 quavers	Level 3

EXAMPLE 2

Which ticket?



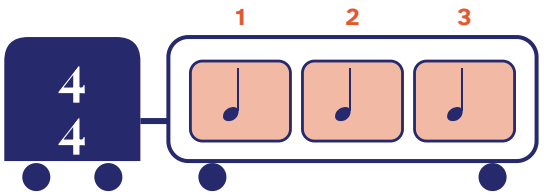
1. **Count the seats:** how many in the carriage? That is the top number.
2. **Which note** sits in one seat?
3. **Its number:** a quaver is 8. Write the ticket.

Three seats, a quaver in each: **3/8**.

PART II · TIME · 4 · CONTINUED

EXAMPLE 3
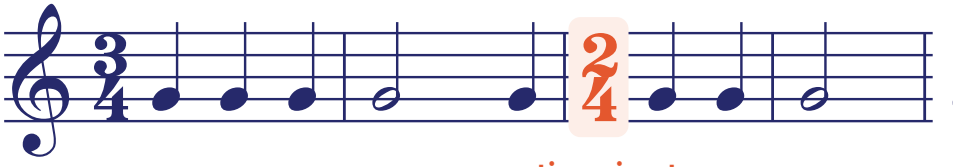
Where does the rest go?



1. **How many seats** in 4/4?
2. **The three crotchets** fill which seats?
3. **Which seat is empty,** and what goes there?

Seat 4 is empty: a **crotchet rest**. Count it: 1 2 3 (4).

Changing time signature
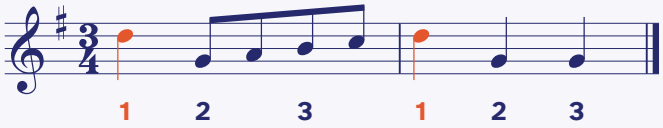


new time signature

2 beats a bar from here on

A new time signature can appear right after a bar line; it holds until the next one. It is written only once, not on every line.

YOU KNOW THIS

Minuet (from the Notebook for Anna Magdalena Bach)



Every bar holds **three crotchet beats**: 1 2 3, 1 2 3, the step of the dance. That is 3/4.

Try it. Count 1 2 3 aloud while someone plays it.

TRAP

- × Reading the bottom number as a count: it names the note that gets one beat.
- × Mixing up 3/4 and 6/8: both hold six quavers, grouped differently (p. 62).

SEE ALSO
Pulse, tempo and the bar p. 50 · Compound time p. 62

PRACTISE IT
Workbook pp. 7–8 · Online: Library › Time signatures

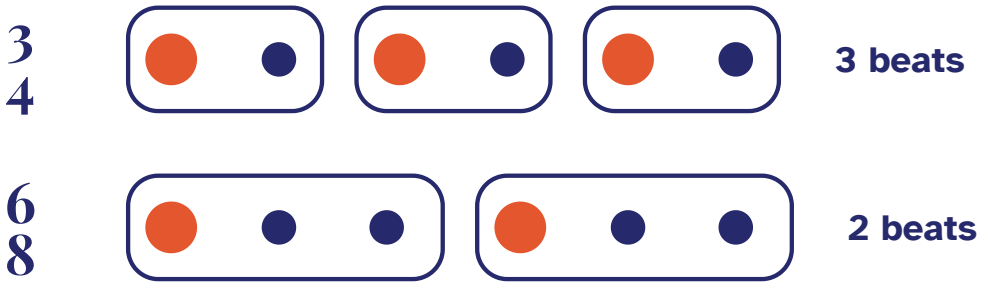
PART II · TIME · 5

Compound and irregular time

Compound time is a skipping rope: each dotted beat splits into **three**. Irregular time keeps you guessing, with **five or seven** counts in uneven groups. (9/4, 12/4 and /16 signatures are rare.)

THE SECRET

Dotted beats split in three: 6/8 is two big beats.



Same six quavers, new groups

SIMPLE OR COMPOUND?

In **simple time** each beat divides into **two**. In **compound time** each beat is a dotted note and divides into **three**.



Simple: one beat splits in 2 **Compound: one beat splits in 3**

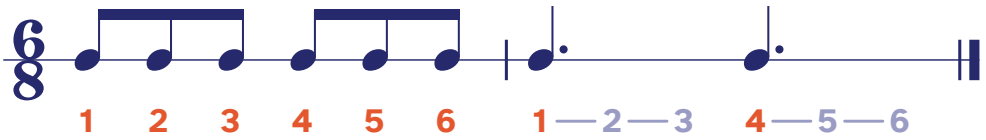
Quick test: a top number of 6, 9 or 12 means compound. Divide it by 3 to find the beats: 6/8 has 2, 9/8 has 3, 12/8 has 4.

Compound time

TIME SIGNATURE	EACH BAR HOLDS	FIRST MET
6/8	2 dotted crotchets	Level 1
9/8	3 dotted crotchets	Level 3
12/8	4 dotted crotchets	Level 3
6/4	2 dotted minims	Level 4

PART II · TIME · 5 · CONTINUED

Counting 6/8



Slowly, count all six quavers. At speed, feel two beats, on 1 and 4: “1 & a, 2 & a”.

HOW TO

Feel compound time

1. **Say “pine-ap-ple”** on every beat and step only on “pine”.
2. **Clap the three syllables** while you step.

EXAMPLE 1

How many beats in 9/8?



1. **The top number, 9:** does it divide by 3?
2. **How many groups of three** fit in 9?
3. **What is each beat**, in quavers?

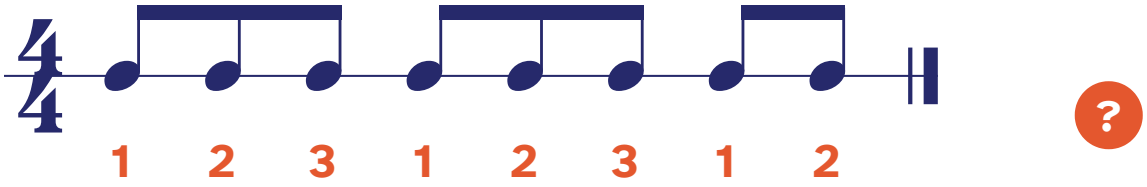
9 ÷ 3 = **three beats**, each a dotted crotchet: “1 2 3, 4 5 6, 7 8 9”.

Uneven groups in 4/4

Many dances keep 4/4 but group the eight quavers unevenly.

EXAMPLE 2

Is this still 4/4?



1. **Count eight quavers** in the bar.
2. **Group them 3 + 3 + 2:** where do the accents fall?
3. **Keep your foot on the beat.** How many foot taps?

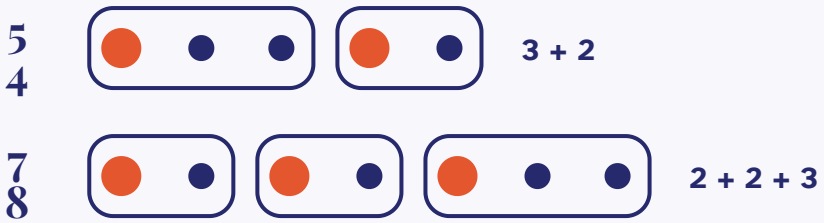
Accents on 1, 4 and 7, but four foot taps: the bar is still **4/4**, only the accents are uneven.

PART II · TIME · 5 · CONTINUED

EXTRA · GOING FURTHER

Irregular time
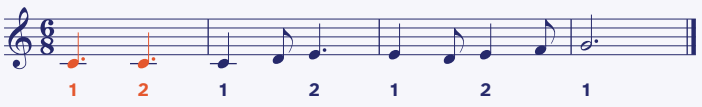
Five or seven counts, grouped unevenly. Met from Level 5.



TIME SIGNATURE	EACH BAR HOLDS	FIRST MET
5/4	5 crotchets: 3 + 2 or 2 + 3	Level 5
7/4	7 crotchets: 4 + 3 or 3 + 4	*Extra*
5/8	5 quavers: 3 + 2 or 2 + 3	*Extra*
7/8	7 quavers: 2 + 2 + 3 or 3 + 2 + 2	*Extra*

YOU KNOW THIS

Row, Row, Row Your Boat



Two big beats in every bar, each a **dotted crotchet**: “Row, row”. Each big beat is worth three quavers: “row your” is long-short, a crotchet and a quaver, filling one big beat. That is 6/8.

Try it. Sway twice per bar while you sing it.

TRAP

- × Reading 6/8 as six crotchet beats: the 8 means quavers.
- × Beaming 6/8 quavers in twos: in compound time they go in threes.
- × Counting 5/4 as four beats and one left over: feel it as 3 + 2 (or 2 + 3), one long group and one short.

SEE ALSO
Time signatures p. 59 · Rhythm: groups and upbeats p. 65

PRACTISE IT
Workbook pp. 9–10 · Online: Rhythm clock

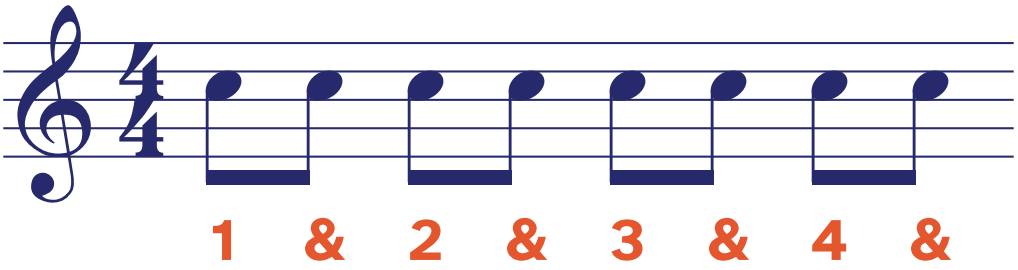
PART II · TIME · 6

Rhythm: groups and upbeats

Say your own name: long and short sounds, that's **rhythm**. The pulse marches steadily on; the rhythm dances around it. How the notes are grouped on the page shows where the beats fall.

THE SECRET

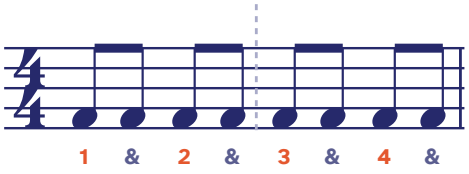
Beams group notes into beats; an upbeat borrows from the last bar.



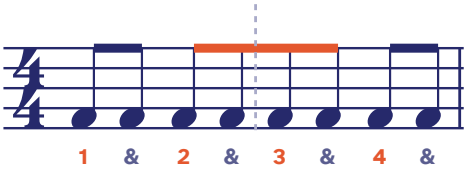
One beam, one beat

Grouping with beams

Beams join the notes of **one beat**, so the beats stay visible. In 4/4 a beam may cover beats 1–2 or 3–4, but never cross the middle of the bar (except in a deliberate grouping such as 3 + 3 + 2). In compound time, quavers are beamed in threes.



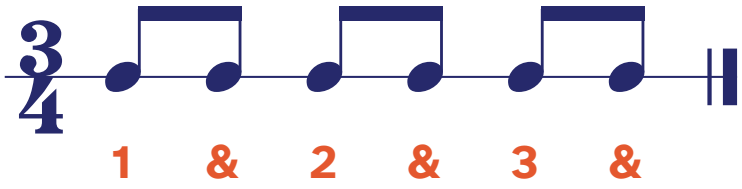
✓ beams show the beats



× a beam across the middle

EXAMPLE 1

Why are six quavers beamed in twos in 3/4?



?

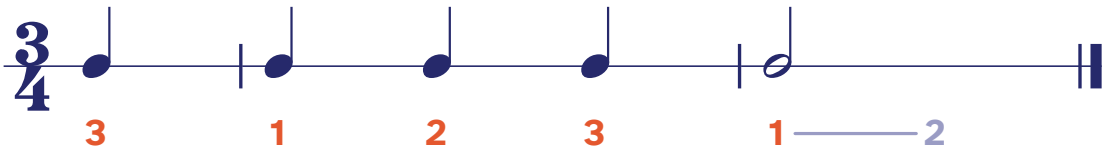
1. **How many beats** does 3/4 have, and what kind?
2. **How many quavers** fit in one beat?
3. **So how many** go under each beam?

Three crotchet beats, two quavers each: **2 + 2 + 2**. Beamed 3 + 3 they would look like 6/8.

PART II · TIME · 6 · CONTINUED

The upbeat (anacrusis)
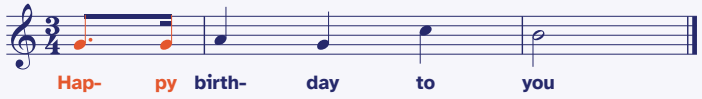
A piece can begin **before** the first full bar, with one or more notes called an upbeat or anacrusis. The last bar is then short by the same amount, so the two together make one full bar. Count the missing beats in silence before you start.



Count “1 2” silently, then play on 3. The upbeat (1 beat) and the last bar (2 beats) make one full bar.

YOU KNOW THIS

Happy Birthday

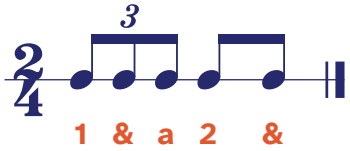


“Hap-py” comes **before** the first strong beat: an upbeat. The strong beat lands on “birth”.

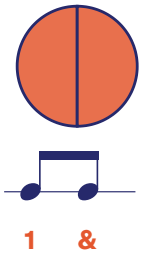
Try it. Sing it and clap only on “birth”, “day” and “you”: you feel where bar 1 starts.

THINK OF IT An upbeat is the breath before you speak: “and-ONE”. You lift on the upbeat so the strong beat can land.

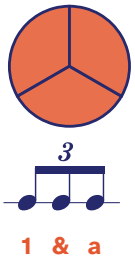
Triplets



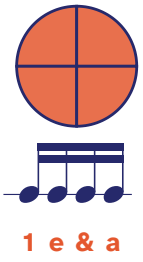
Triplet: three exactly equal notes in the time of two. First met: Level 2.



Two quavers: one beat cut in 2



A **triplet**: one beat cut in 3

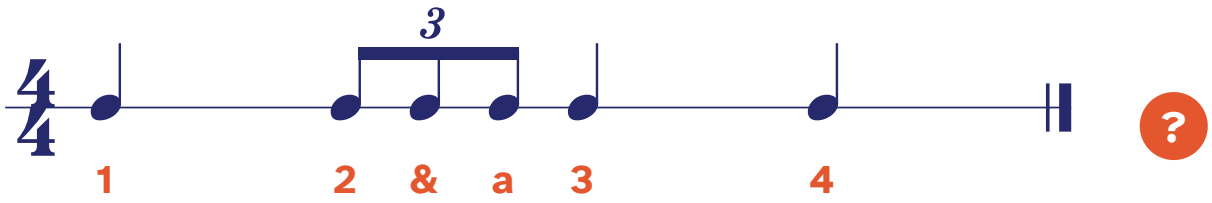


Four semiquavers: one beat cut in 4

PART II · TIME · 6 · CONTINUED

EXAMPLE 2

Where is the triplet, and how do you count it?



1. **Count the bar:** four crotchet beats.
2. **Find the little 3.** Which beat do the three quavers share?
3. **Say it:** "2 & a" on that beat.

Beat 2: "1, **2 & a**, 3, 4" (some say "trip-o-let"). Three notes squeeze into one beat; the beat never moves.

EXAMPLE 3

Count a bar of mixed values
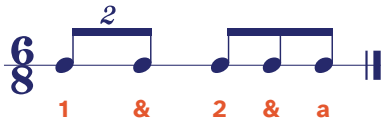


1. **Find the beats:** four crotchet beats, one per number.
2. **Beat by beat:** how many notes share each beat?
3. **Say it:** "&" for 2 notes, "e & a" for 4, "& a" for a triplet.

"1, 2 &, 3 e & a, 4 & a": crotchet, two quavers, four semiquavers, a triplet. **One beat each.**

EXTRA · GOING FURTHER

Duplet



Two notes in the time of three, in compound time: the triplet turned inside out.

SEE ALSO

Notes and rests p. 53 · Rhythm: off the beat p. 68

PRACTISE IT

Workbook pp. 11–12 · Online: Rhythm clock

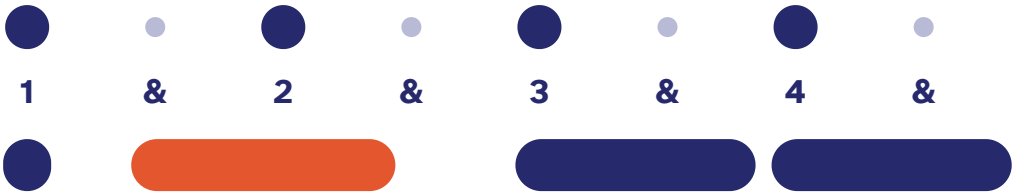
PART II · TIME · 7

Rhythm: off the beat

Now the fun part: rhythm that teases the beat. It only works if the beat underneath stays rock-steady.

THE SECRET

Keep the beat rock-steady and let the rhythm tease it.



starts on “&”, held over beat 2

A note between the beats

Swing Level ½

Common from the first pieces: jazz, blues and many easy modern pieces are marked *swing*. Pairs of quavers are written evenly but played **long–short**, like the first and last notes of a triplet.



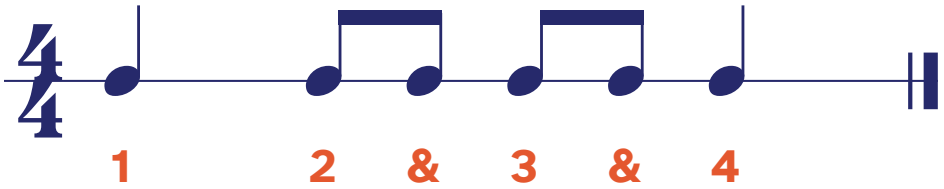
Written



Played

EXAMPLE 1

Which notes swing?



?

1. **Find the quaver pairs.** On which beats?
2. **Play each pair long–short:** “doo-ba”.
3. **What about the crotchets?**

Only the **pairs** (beats 2 and 3) swing; the crotchets and the beat underneath stay even.

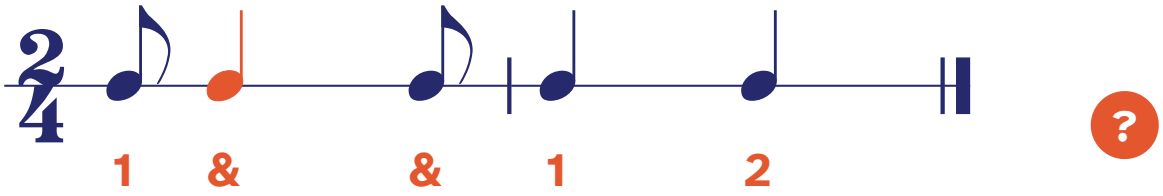
PART II · TIME · 7 · CONTINUED

Syncopation Level 4

A note starts on the “&”, between the beats, and is held through the next beat. Feel that beat even though nothing is played on it.

EXAMPLE 2

Where does the long note start?
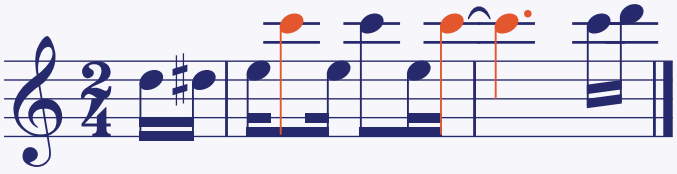


1. **Tap the beats:** 1, 2.
2. **Find the red crotchet.** Does it start on a beat, or on the “&”?
3. **Hold it:** through which beat?

It starts on the “&” and holds through beat 2: the long note starts **off the beat**. That is syncopation.

YOU KNOW THIS

The Entertainer (Scott Joplin)



The high **C** keeps landing just after the beat, not on it: syncopation, the bounce of ragtime.

Try it. Tap the beat with your foot and hum the tune: hear the C slip between the taps.

THINK OF IT Syncopation is a skip in your walk: a step that lands between the beats.

HOW TO

Feel off-beat rhythm

1. **Tap a steady beat** with your foot.
2. **Clap only between the taps**, on the “&”.
3. **If the foot starts to follow the hands,** slow down.

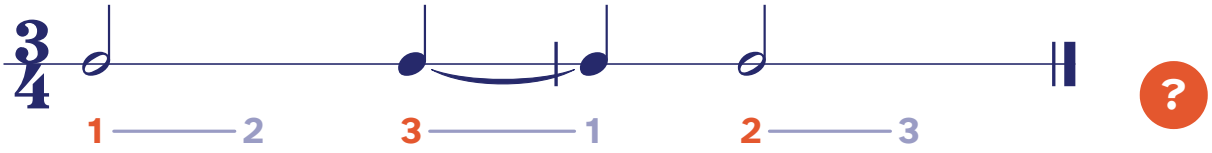
PART II · TIME · 7 · CONTINUED

Hemiola Level 4

Two bars of 3/4 felt as three bars of two: three minims across the bar line. Common at the ends of phrases in Baroque dances.

EXAMPLE 3

Two bars of 3, or one big bar?



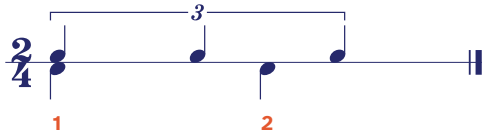
1. **Count as written:** "1 2 3, 1 2 3".
2. **Look at the notes:** how many beats does each minim last?
3. **Feel each minim** as one big beat. How many big beats?

Three minims of two beats: the six beats are felt as **three big ones**. That is a hemiola.

EXTRA · GOING FURTHER

Polyrhythm and rubato

Polyrhythm (Level 7): two rhythms at once.



Three against two: a triplet above, two crotchets below, starting together.

Rubato: time is stretched and then given back, for expression: the music leans into a phrase and catches up after it. The pulse always returns. Marked *rubato*, or simply part of the style in much music from the 1800s.



TRAP

- × Rushing the short notes after a long one: keep counting inside the long note.
- × Swinging the crotchets: only the quaver pairs swing.

SEE ALSO

Rhythm: groups and upbeats p. 65 · Speed words p. 82

PRACTISE IT

Workbook pp. 13–14 · Online: Rhythm clock

PART II · TIME · 8

Repeats and road signs

Music often says “play that again”. Instead of writing the same bars twice, it uses **repeat signs** and **road signs**. Read them like a map: they tell you which bar comes next.

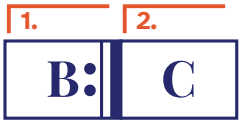
THE SECRET

Follow the map: jump back at the sign, stop at Fine, or jump to the Coda.



You play: A → B → A → B → C

Two dots facing back mean: go back and play it again

SIGN	NAME	WHAT YOU DO
	**repeat signs**	play the bars between them twice (with only the end sign: go back to the start)
	**1st and 2nd time bars**	first time play the 1. bar; after the repeat skip it and play the 2. bar
D.C.	**da capo**	“from the head”: go back to the very beginning
	**D.S.** (dal segno)	“from the sign”: go back to the segno
Fine	**fine**	“the end”: after a D.C. or D.S., stop here
	**coda**	“tail”: at “To Coda”, jump to the coda sign and play the ending

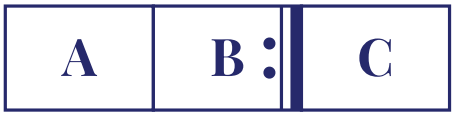
THE RULE

Follow the map in order. At a jump (D.C., D.S.) go back; then the first time you meet Fine, stop; or at To Coda, jump to the coda.

PART II · TIME · 8 · CONTINUED

EXAMPLE 1

In what order do you play these bars?



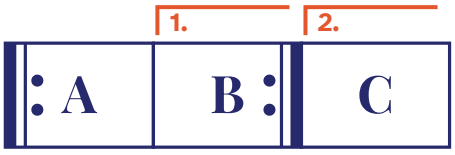
You play: ? ? ? ? ?

1. **Play A and B.**
2. **B ends with a repeat sign** facing back. There is no start sign: where do you go back to?
3. **Play it again,** then carry on.

Back to the very start: **A B A B C**.

EXAMPLE 2

First and second time



You play: ? ? ? ?

1. **First time through:** play A, then the bar marked 1.
2. **The repeat sign** sends you back to A.
3. **Second time:** which bar do you skip, and which do you play?

A B, A C: **A B A C**. The 1. bar is skipped the second time.

GAME

How many bars do you play?

1	2	3
|: A B :|	A |: B C :| D	A B (Fine) C D.C.

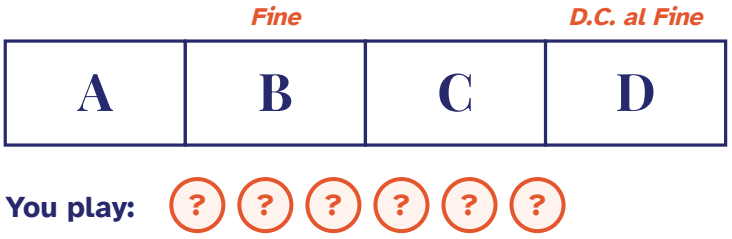
Each letter is one bar. Follow the signs and count every bar you play.

Answer: 1 four (A B A B) · 2 six (A B C B C D) · 3 five (A B C A B).

PART II · TIME · 8 · CONTINUED

EXAMPLE 3

D.C. al Fine

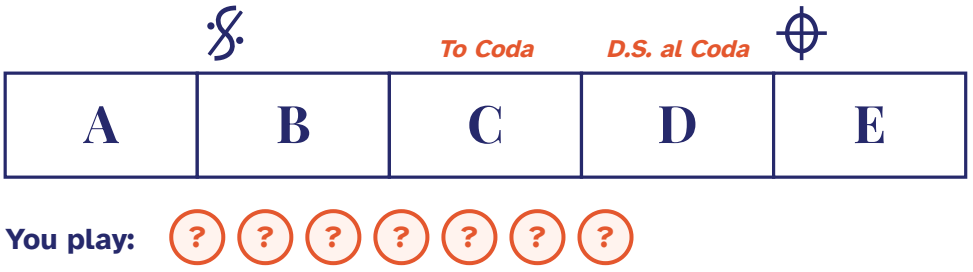


1. **Play straight through** to D.
2. **D.C.** means go back: to where?
3. **al Fine:** where do you stop the second time?

A B C D, then from the head to Fine: **A B C D A B**.

EXAMPLE 4

D.S. al Coda



1. **Play through** to D. (Ignore "To Coda" the first time.)
2. **D.S.** sends you back to the sign: which bar has it?
3. **Play on to "To Coda",** then jump. Where?

A B C D, back to the sign, B C, jump to the coda: **A B C D B C E**.

TRAP

- × Taking the repeat again after a D.C.: on the way back, skip the repeats (unless the music says otherwise).
- × Jumping at "To Coda" the first time through: it only works after the D.S. or D.C.

SEE ALSO
Pulse, tempo and the bar p. 50 · Time signatures p. 59

PRACTISE IT
Workbook pp. 15–16 · Online: Library › Signs

PART II · TIME · TIPS

When the rhythm slips

A rhythm that slips is nearly always a beat that was not counted. Find which beat, count it out loud, and the rest of the bar usually falls into place.

TIP

What you notice, what to check

WHAT YOU NOTICE	CHECK	TURN TO
It speeds up or slows down	**the pulse**: count one bar aloud before you start	p. 50
A rest gets skipped	**the rest**: it is counted just like a note	p. 53
Long notes come out short	**the hold**: count every beat of a minim, dot or tie	p. 56
The bar feels too long or too short	**the time signature**: how many counts, which note is one	p. 59
An off-beat note lands on the beat	**the "&"**: keep the beat in your foot and count it	p. 68

Four ways to steady a rhythm

1. **Count out loud**
   Say the counts while you play, not in your head: a slip you can hear is a slip you can fix.

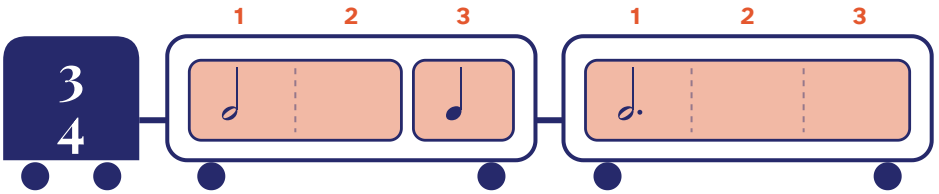
2. **Tap, then play**
   Tap the rhythm on the lid and say the counts; play only when the tapping is steady.

3. **Walk the beat**
   Step the pulse while you clap the rhythm, so the beat lives in your feet.

4. **Split the beat**
   For dots and quavers, count "1 & 2 &": the extra "&" shows exactly where each note goes.

EXAMPLE

Count the long notes



1. **Say 1 2 3** once through before you play, to feel the beat.
2. **The minim books seats 1 and 2:** keep saying "2" while it sounds.
3. **The dotted minim books all three:** let go on the next "1", not before.

Long notes are where counting slips: **say every seat** they book.

THINK OF IT Like a dance partner: the beat leads, the rhythm follows.